

Angel Hsing-Chi Hwang

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Keywords: **Human-AI Collaboration, Human-Agent Teamwork, HCI, CSCW, Digital Mental Health, Future of Work**

Academic & Research Appointments

- 2024 – **University of Southern California**
Assistant Professor of Communication & Computer Science
Annenberg School for Communication & Journalism
Thomas Lord Department of Computer Science (Joint Appointment)
Associate Director, USC Center for AI in Society
- 2026 – 2027 **Princeton University**
Visiting Research Scholar
Center for Information Technology Policy
- 2026 – 2027 **Harvard University**
Research Fellow
Berkman Klein Center for Internet & Society
- 2023 – 2024 **Cornell University**
Postdoctoral Research Associate (PIs: Qian Yang, Wendy Ju)
Ann S. Bowers College of Computing and Information Science
- 2023 – 2024 **Sony AI**
Research Scientist
- 2022 – 2023 **Google Research**
PhD Student Researcher
- 2021 – 2023 **Cornell Center for Social Sciences**
Senior Data Science Fellow

Other Short-Term Research Appointments:

Adobe, Doctoral Research Internship, 2023
Microsoft Research (FATE), Doctoral Research Internship, 2023
Sony AI, Doctoral Research Internship, 2022
Accenture Labs, Research Associate Principal, 2022

Education

- 2019 – 2023 **Cornell University**
PhD in Communication with Concentration in Human-Computer Interaction
Committee: Andrea Stevenson Won, Susan Fussell, Malte Jung, Mor Naaman
Other Short-Term Trainings during PhD: Neuropsychology (Harvard); Computational Social Science (University of Rochester); Human-Centered Design (MIT)

- 2016 – 2018 **The University of Texas at Austin**
Master’s in Business Analytics and Applied Statistics
- 2012 – 2016 **The University of Hong Kong**
Bachelor in Business Administration, *First Division Honor*

Honors & Awards

- 2026 Center for Information Technology Policy Fellowship, Princeton University
- 2026 Berkman Klein Center for Internet & Society Fellowship, Harvard University
- 2026 Top Methodology Paper Award, International Communication Association (ICA)
- 2021, 2024, 2026 ACM CHI Best Paper Honorable Mention (*top 5% of 4,000+ papers*)
- 2026 Spotlight Paper for Oral Presentation, International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) (*top 1% of 11,000+ papers*)
- 2026 Best Paper in Human-Machine Communication, International Communication Association (ICA)
- 2025 Google Academic Research Award (*1 of 26 awarded teams worldwide*)
- 2025 Annenberg Dean’s Research Award, USC
- 2024 Slack Academic Research Award (*1 of 4 awardees nationwide*)
- 2023 DAAD Human-Centered AI Postdoctoral Fellow (*1 of 30 awardees worldwide*)
- 2022 - 2023 PhD Student Research Fellow, Google Research (*1 of 11 fellows nationwide*)
- 2023 Anson E. Rowe Award for Advanced Graduate Student, Cornell University
- 2022 Apple AI/ML Scholars Fellowship
- 2022 PhD Dissertation Fellowship, Cornell University
- 2022 Glass Family Fellowship, Cornell University
- 2021 - 2023 Senior Data Science Fellowship, Cornell University (*1 of 3 fellows university-wide*)
- 2021 - 2022 Graduate Research Scholarship, Ministry of Education (*1 of 4 awardees nationwide*)
- 2021 Anson E. Rowe Award for Promising Graduate Student, Cornell University
- 2021 Top Cited Article 2020-2021, Psychology & Marketing
- 2020 Ada Lovelace Fellowship Nominee, Microsoft Research
- 2013 - 2016 First Division Honor & Outstanding International Students, University of Hong Kong

Research Grants

Total Awarded Amount: \$571,746

- 2026 **USC OORI Research Catalyst Program**
“Democratizing Algorithmic Data-Driven Decision-Making”
(Seed grant for NSF Robust Intelligence (RI))
Co-PIs: Phebe Vayanos, Jieyu Zhao, and Peter Phung (All USC)
Awarded amount: \$150,290

2025 - 2026	Google Research – AI Trust, Safety, & Security Program <i>“Exiting Harmful Reliance: Identifying Crises & Escalation Needs in AI Companionships”</i> Co-PI: Munmun De Choudhury (Georgia Tech) Awarded amount: \$100,000 <i>(1 of 26 awarded teams worldwide)</i>
2026 - 2027	Amazon Science <i>“Crisis Detection in AI Companionship: Accounting for Users’ Mental Health Literacy and Culturally Sensitive Relational Dynamics”</i> Co-PI: Jieyu Zhao (USC) Awarded amount: \$100,000
2025	Annenberg Dean’s Research Award <i>“Investigating the Impact of AI Adoption in Creator Ecosystem”</i> Awarded amount: \$10,000
2024	Slack Academic Research Grant <i>“Collaborative Creative Portfolio Reviewing with Generative AI”</i> Co-PI: Marlon Twyman II Awarded amount: \$10,000
2024	USC Center on Generative AI & Society <i>“Expressive Co-Creation With AI Text Companions for Everyday Wellness”</i> Awarded amount: \$15,000
2024	Cornell Center for Data Science for Enterprise & Society <i>“Everyday Sensing and AI for Mental Health Care: Navigating a Tipping Point”</i> Co-PIs: Qian Yang, Tanzeem Choudhury, and Fei Wang Awarded amount: \$40,000
2023	DAAD Human-Centered AI Postdoctoral Fellowship Awarded amount: \$30,000
2023, 2021	Anson E. Rowe Award for Graduate Student Awarded amount: \$5,609
2022 - 2023	Cornell Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship Awarded amount: \$50,058
2022	Glass Family Fellowship Awarded amount: \$1,695
2021 - 2023	Cornell Center for Social Sciences – Senior Data Science Fellowship Awarded amount: \$27,094
2021 - 2022	Ministry of Education Awarded amount: \$32,000

Academic Leadership, Outreach, & Research Events Organized

Present	Associate Director, USC Center for Artificial Intelligence in Society
Present	Co-Director, Media As SocioTechnical Systems, A Cross-Campus Initiative at USC
2026	Co-Organizer, CSCW Workshop on Broader Impacts of GenAI in Communication

2026 Co-Organizer, CSCW Workshop on Designing Social Technology
 2026 Co-Organizer, FAccT Workshop on AI Disclosure and Ownership, and Accountability
 2026 Co-Chair, Annual Symposium, USC Center for Artificial Intelligence in Society
 2025 Organizer, CSCW Panel on LLMs as Research Tools
 2025 Co-Organizer, Symposium on Synthetic Data & Behavioral Research, Society of Experimental Social Psychology (SESP)
 2025 Co-Organizer, AI & Mental Health Thought Summit, Cornell University
 2025 Co-Organizer, CHIWORK Workshop on AI Disclosure and Accountability
 2025 Organizer, Panel on Human Subjects Research in the Age of Generative AI, ACM CHI
 2025 Organizing Committee, Annual Symposium, USC Center for Artificial Intelligence in Society

Invited Talks, Panels, & Workshops

2026 Human-AI Complementarity Workshop, NSF AI Institute for Societal Decision Making (*1 of 12 speakers selected from ~200 candidates*)
 2026 Trust and Safety Research Conference, Stanford University
 2026 Society for Digital Mental Health Annual Meeting
 2026 Community-Centered AI Summit, Cornell University
 2026 Keynote, Communication Horizons Conference, UC Davis
 2026 Keynote, International Workshop on the 7th Cyber Social Threats at International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM 2026)
 2026 AI x Health Workshop, Georgia Institute of Technology
 2026 Workshop on Social and Emotional Uses of AI at The ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2026)
 2026 Summit on Persuasion in AI, UC Irvine
 2026 Computing Research Association (CRA) Early Career Workshop
 2026 Department of Communication and Department of Psychology Colloquium, UCLA
 2025 Department of Computer Science Colloquium, USC
 2025 Summit on Responsible Computing, AI, and Society, Georgia Institute of Technology
 2025 Society of Experimental Social Psychology
 2025 Responsible Data Workshop, Arizona State University
 2024, 2025 Media As Socio-Technical Systems (MASTS) Seminar, USC
 2025 Columbia Journalism School, Columbia University
 2025 Data & Society
 2025 Slack Workforce Lab
 2025 Thought Summit on LLMs And Society, Global AI Initiative
 2023, 2024, 2025 Annenberg Research Seminar, USC
 2024 USC Center for AI in Society Seminar, USC
 2024 Information Sciences Institute, USC
 2024 School of Cinematic Arts, USC
 2024 Department of Information Science Colloquium, Cornell University
 2022, 2023 Google Research
 2022, 2023, 2024 Sony AI Research

2023	Adobe Research
2021, 2022	Department of Communication Colloquium, Cornell University
2022	Work in the Age of Intelligent Machine (WAIM) Research Coordination Network
2022	Doctoral Consortium, International Communication Association (ICA)
2022	Human-Machine Communication Pre-Conference, International Communication Association (ICA)
2022	XR Monthly Seminar, Cornell Tech
2022	Department of Computer Science, Harvard University
2021	AI in Society Workshop, Cornell University
2021	AI & Design Workshop, Carnegie Mellon University
2021	Workshop on Human-Centered AI, Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) <i>Spotlight workshop paper (<4% of all papers)</i>

Publications

* = co-authorship with equal contribution;

∞ = authors listed in alphabetical order;

⊕ = students that I mentored;

IF = 5-year impact factor at the time of acceptance

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- J12. Feuerriegel, S., Barrie, C., Crockett, M. J., Globig, L. K., Mirea, D. M., Spirling, A., Yang, D., ... Hwang, A. H.-C.[∞] ... Rathje, S., Ribeiro, M. H. (2026) A Consensus-based Reporting Checklist for Large Language Models in Behavioral and Social Science. ***Nature Human Behaviour*** (IF = 19.7)
- J11. Daphnis, S. I. M. L.[⊕], Wu, K., Yu, Q., Rives, H.[⊕], Hwang, A. H.-C., Sabet, M., Won, A. S. (2025) The Effects of Companionship from Strangers and Companions on Pain Thresholds in Immersive Virtual Reality: A Randomized Controlled Trial. ***Pain Medicine*** (IF = 6.7; Registered Clinical Trials: [NCT05335057](https://doi.org/10.1093/pm/pnaf120))
<https://doi.org/10.1093/pm/pnaf120>
- J10. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2026) Rethinking Socio-Technical Harms of Large Foundation Models: A Critical Reflection Through Scale Hacking. ***International Journal of Communication*** (IF = 1.9) <https://doi.org/10.65476/e20tjk66>
- J9. Lauharatanahirun, N., Won, A. S., & Hwang, A. H.-C. (2024) External and Internal Attribution in Human-Agent Interaction: Insights from Neuroscience and Virtual Reality. ***Human-Machine Communication*** (IF = 9.9) <https://doi.org/10.30658/hmc.8.6>
- J8. Ahn, S. J., Lee, J., Hwang, A. H.-C., Won, A. S., Eden, A., & Guthrie, W. S. (2024) Conferencing Together in Social VR: Bringing Agency Back into Affordances-based Approaches in Communication Scholarship. ***The Information Society*** (IF = 3.9) <https://doi.org/10.1080/01972243.2024.2358344>

- J7. Yang, Y.-Y., Hwang, A. H.-C., Wu, C.-T., Huang, T.-R. (2022) Person-identifying brain-prints are stably embedded in EEG mindprints. *Nature Scientific Reports* (IF = 5.5) <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-022-21384-0>
- J6. Herman, L. M.* & Hwang, A. H.-C.* (2022) In the eye of the beholder: A viewer-defined conception of online visual creativity. *New Media & Society* (IF = 7.2) <https://doi.org/10.1177/14614448221089604>
- J5. Oh, J. & Hwang, A. H.-C. (2021) How interactive data visualization enhances the persuasiveness of COVID-19 news stories: The mediating role of fear and the moderating role of political orientation. *Journal of Broadcasting & Electronic Media* (IF = 3.6) <https://doi.org/10.1080/08838151.2021.1999958>
- J4. Oh, J., Lim, H. Y., & Hwang, A. H.-C. (2021) How interactive storytelling persuades: The mediating role of website contingency and narrative transportation. *Journal of Broadcasting & Electronic Media* (IF= 3.6) <https://doi.org/10.1080/08838151.2020.1848180>
- J3. Oh, J., Hwang, A. H.-C., & Lim, H. Y. (2020) How interactive data visualization and users' BMI (body mass index) influence obesity prevention intentions: The mediating effect of cognitive absorption. *Health Communication* (IF= 3.6) <https://doi.org/10.1080/10410236.2020.1791376>
- J2. Hwang, A. H.-C., Oh, J., & Scheinbaum, A. C. (2020) Interactive music for multisensory e-commerce: The moderating role of online consumer involvement in experiential value, cognitive value, and purchase intention. *Psychology & Marketing* (IF= 5.5) <https://doi.org/10.1002/mar.21338>
Top Cited Paper of the Year in Psychology & Marketing, 2020–2021
- J1. Hwang, A. H.-C., & Oh, J. (2020) Interacting with background music engages e-customers more: The impact of interactive music on consumer perception and behavioral intention. *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services* (IF= 11.0) <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jretconser.2019.101928>

Peer-Reviewed Conference Papers (Archival)

Top-tier venues in human-computer interaction (HCI) include ACM conferences such as CHI, CSCW, and DIS. Top-tier venues in artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning (ML) include conferences such as NeurIPS, ICML, and ICLR. Top-tier venues in natural language processing (NLP) include ACL, EMNLP, and NAACL. These conferences are peer-reviewed with acceptance rates around 20–25% in the past few years. These conference papers are published as journal-style full papers.

- C31. Morabito, R., McDonald, T., Viswanath, C., Hwang, A. H.-C., Gaube, S., Kabbara, J., Emami, A. (Accepted) Rating the Pitch, Not the Product: User Evaluations of LLMs Reflect Expectations More Than Performance. *Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP 2026)* <https://arxiv.org/abs/2607.05113>

- C30. Chu, M. D., Wu, Y., Chen, Z., Hwang, A. H.-C., Luceri, L. (Accepted) When Chatbots Accommodate: What AI Companions Optimize for in Vulnerable Conversations. *Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP 2026)* <https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.04431>
- C29. Berman, G., Cooper, N., Hwang, A. H.-C., Deng, W. H., Shelby, R., Hutchinson, B. (Accepted) "Death by a thousand taxonomies?": AI Risk Classification In Practice. *AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES 2026)* <https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.06831>
- C28. Kang, E. J., Lin, F., Hwang, A. H.-C. (Accepted) Policy or Community?: Supporting Individual Model Creators' Open Model Development in Model Marketplaces. *AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES 2026)* <https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.19354>
- C27. Chen, S., Patil, N., Pan, H., Hwang, A. H.-C., Du, Y., Liu, R., Zhao, J. (2026) MED-COPILOT: A Medical Assistant Powered by GraphRAG and Similar Patient Case Retrieval. *Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL 2026)* <https://aclanthology.org/2026.acl-demo.49/>
- C26. Li, Y.[Ⓢ], Yao, J., Bunyi, J. B. S.[Ⓢ], Frank, A. C., Hwang, A. H.-C., Liu, R. (2026) Counsel-Bench: A Large-Scale Expert Evaluation and Adversarial Benchmark of Large Language Models in Mental Health Counseling. *Proceedings of the International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2026)* <https://arxiv.org/abs/2506.08584>
Selected as spotlight paper for oral presentation (top 1% of 11,000+ papers)
- C25. Hwang, A. H. C., Wong, S.[Ⓢ], Chen, B.[Ⓢ], He, J., Do, H. J. (2026) "Better Ask for Forgiveness than Permission": Practices and Policies of AI Disclosure in Freelance Work. *Proceedings of the ACM 2026 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2026)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791920>
Best Paper Honorable Mention (< top 5% among 4,000+ papers)
- C24. Cooper, N.^{*}, Guridi, J. A.^{*}, Hwang, A. H.-C.^{*}, Kolko, B., McGinty, E. E., Yang, Q. (2026) Framing Responsible Design of AI for Mental Well-Being: AI as Primary Care, Nutritional Supplement, or Yoga Instructor? *Proceedings of the ACM 2026 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2026)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791556>
- C23. Manoli, A., Pauketat, J. V. T., Ladak, A., Noh, H., Hwang, A. H.-C., Anthis, J. R. (2026) Digital Companionship: Overlapping Uses of AI Companions and AI Assistants. *Proceedings of the ACM 2026 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2026)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791331>
- C22. Hwang, A. H.-C., Liao, Q. V., Olteanu, A., Blodgett, S. L., & Trischler, A. (2025) "It was 80% me, 20% AI": Seeking Authenticity in Creative Writing with Large-Language Models. *Proceedings of the ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW 2025)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3711020>

- C21. Guridi, J. A.[Ⓢ], Hwang, A. H.-C., Santo, D., Goula, M., Cheyre, C., Humphreys, L., & Rangel, M. (2025) From Fake Perfects to Conversational Imperfects: Exploring Image-Generative AI as a Boundary Object for Participatory Design of Public Spaces. *Proceedings of the ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW 2025)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3710912>
- C20. Sandhaus, H.[Ⓢ], Hwang, A. H.-C., Yang, Q., & Ju, W. (2025) My Precious Crash Data: Barriers and Opportunities in Encouraging Autonomous Driving Companies to Share Safety-Critical Data. *Proceedings of the ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW 2025)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3757493>
- C19. Hwang, A. H.-C., Le Quéré, M. A., Schroeder, H., Cuevas, A., Dow, S. P., Kapania, S., & Rho, E. (2025) Scale, Engage, or Both?: Potential and Perils of Applying Large Language Models in Interview and Conversation-Based Research. *Companion of the Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW 2025)* <https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3715070.3748284>
- C18. Johnston, C. M.[Ⓢ], Koumoundouros, O., Hwang, A. H.-C., Onasch-Vera, L., Rice, E., Vayanos, P. (2025) Toward AI Matching Policies in Homeless Services: A Qualitative Study with Policymakers. *Proceedings of the 2025 AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES 2025)* <https://doi.org/10.1609/aies.v8i2.36635>
- C17. Hwang, A. H.-C., and Yang, Y.-Y. (2025) Popularity Matters: Revealing Their Use of AI Tools Harms Freelancers with Smaller Follower Bases. *Proceedings of Academy of Management Annual Meeting (AOM 2025)* <https://doi.org/10.5465/AMPROC.2025.20292abstract>
- C16. Maruyama, K., Hwang, A. H.-C., & Besold, T. R. (2025) Bridging Perceptual Gaps in Food NLP: A Structured Approach Using Sensory Anchors. In *Proceedings of the Fourth Workshop on NLP for Positive Impact (NLP4PI)*, Association for Computational Linguistics (**ACL 2025**) <https://doi.org/10.18653/v1/2025.nlp4pi-1.8>
- C15. Do, H. J., Feldman, M. Q., He, J., Hwang, A. H.-C., Kim, S. (2025) Navigating Generative AI Disclosure, Ownership, and Accountability in Co-Creative Domains. *Adjunct Proceedings of the 4th Annual Symposium on Human-Computer Interaction for Work (CHIWORK 2025)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3707640.3729212>
- C14. Hwang, A. H.-C., Bernstein, M. S., Sundar, S. S., Zhang, R., Horta Ribeiro, M., Lu, Y., Chang, S., Wu, S. Yang, A., Williams, D., Park, J. S., Ognyanova, K., Xiao, Z., Shamma, D. A. (2025) Human Subjects Research in the Age of Generative AI: Opportunities and Challenges of Applying LLM-Simulated Data to HCI Studies *Proceedings of the ACM 2025 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2025)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3706599.3716299>
- C13. Hwang, A. H.-C., Siy, J. O., Shelby, R. M., & Lentz, A. (2024) In whose voice?: Examining Agent Representation of People in Social Interaction through AI Generative Audio. *Proceedings of ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference. (DIS 2024)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3643834.3661555>

- C12. Hwang, A. H.-C., Adler, D., Friedenberg, M., & Yang, Q. (2024) Societal-Scale Human-AI Interaction Design?: Investigating How Hospitals and Companies Integrate Pervasive Sensing into Mental Healthcare Ecosystems. *Proceedings of the ACM 2024 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2024)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3613904.3642793>
- C11. Hwang, A. H.-C. & Won, A. S. (2024) The Sound of Support: The Presence of Gendered Voice Agent as Support to Minority Teammates in Gender-Imbalanced Team. *Proceedings of the ACM 2024 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2024)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3613904.3642202>
Best Paper Honorable Mention (< top 5% among 4,000+ papers)
- C10. Ebel, P., Bazilinskyy, P., Hwang, A. H.-C., Ju, W., Sandhaus, H., Srinivasan, A. R., Yang, Q., & Wintersberger, P. (2023) Breaking Barriers: Workshop on Open Data Practices in AutoUI Research. *Adjunct Proceedings of the 15th International Conference on Automotive User Interfaces and Interactive Vehicular Applications (AutoUI)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3581961.3609835>
- C9. Hwang, A. H.-C., Badreddine, S., Gifford, F., & Besold, T. R. (2023) Recipe 2.0: Information Presentation for AI-Supported Culinary Idea Generation. *Proceedings of the 14th International Conference on Computational Creativity (ICCC)* [[doi](#)]
- C8. Hwang, A. H.-C. & Won, A. S. (2022) AI in Your Mind: Counterbalancing Perceived Agency and Experience in Human-AI Interaction. *Proceedings of the ACM 2022 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2022)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3491101.3519833>
- C7. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2022) Too Late to be Creative? AI-Empowered Tools in Creative Processes. *Proceedings of the ACM 2022 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2022)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3491101.3503549>
- C6. Hwang, A. H.-C.*, Kim, J.*, Lobo, S. N.[⊕], Shu, Y.[⊕], & Won, A. S. (2022) Being there to learn: Narrative style and cross-platform comparison for 360-degree educational videos. *Proceedings of the ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW 2022)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3555169>
- C5. Hwang, A. H.-C.*, Wang, C. Y.*, Yang, Y. Y., & Won, A. S. (2021) Hide and Seek: Choices of Virtual Backgrounds in Video Chats and Their Effects on Perception. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW 2021)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3476044>
- C4. Hwang, A. H.-C., Won, A. S. (2021) IdeaBot: Investigating Social Facilitation in Human-Machine Team Creativity. *The ACM 2021 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2021)* <https://doi.org/10.1145/3411764.3445270>
Best Paper Honorable Mention (< top 5% among 4,000+ papers)
- C3. Hwang, A. H.-C., Sun, Y., McKee, C., & Won, A. S. (2020) Real or Sur-real: A Pilot Study on Creative Idea Generation in MR vs. VR. *Proceedings of 2020 IEEE Conference on Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces (IEEE VR 2020)* <https://doi.org/10.1109/VRW50115.2020.00189>

- C2. Hwang, A. H.-C., Sun, Y., Tamir, N., & Won, A. S. (2020) Pain Experience in Social VR: Comparing Companionship from Close Others and Stranger. *Proceedings of 2020 IEEE Conference on Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces (IEEE VR 2020)* <https://doi.org/10.1109/VRW50115.2020.00140>
- C1. Chan, C*, Hwang, A. H.-C.*, Sun, D., Birckhead, B., & Won, A. S. (2020) Minimal Embodiment: Effects of a Portable Version of a Virtual Disembodiment Experience on Fear of Death. *Proceedings of 2020 IEEE Conference on Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces (IEEE VR 2020)* <https://doi.org/10.1109/VRW50115.2020.00224>

Peer-Reviewed Extended Abstracts and Non-Archival Conference Papers

- 27. Wan, C., Hwang, A. H.-C. (2026) The Agency Dynamics in Human-AI Communication: Understanding How Chatbot Role and Task Outcome Influence Self-Attribution. *The 76th Annual International Communication Conference. (ICA 2026)*
Best Paper Award in Human-Machine Communication, ICA 2026
- 26. Wan, C., Hwang, A. H.-C. (2026) From Content to Strategy: Understanding the Motivations, Processes, and Impacts of AI-Guided Communication. *The 76th Annual International Communication Conference. (ICA 2026)*
- 25. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2025) From Individual Interaction to Ecosystem: Assessing Harm in Social and Emotional AI. In *Workshop on Social and Emotional Uses of AI at the ACM 2026 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2026)*
- 24. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2025) Repurposing Human Subjects Research as Driver of Responsible AI Design. *Summit on Responsible Computing, AI, and Society*
- 23. Hwang, A. H.-C., Guridi, J. A., Sandhaus, H., & Yang, Q. (2025) Exploring AI Technology and Policy Co-Development: Insights from Seventeen AI Regulatory Sandboxes. In *Workshop on Design for Hope: Cultivating Deliberate Hope in the Face of Complex Societal Challenges at The ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW 2025)* [\[Paper link\]](#)
- 22. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2025) Disclosing AI, Questioning Authenticity: How Transparency Shapes the Value of AI-Generated Professional Work. *INFORMS Annual Meeting*.
- 21. Hwang, A. H.-C., Won, A. S. (2024) Social Comparison and Reliance on Partner Competence in Human-Agent Teamwork. *The 74th Annual International Communication Conference. (ICA 2024)*
- 20. Hwang, A. H.-C. & Yang, Y. Y. (2025) The Dual Impact of AI Use Disclosure: Harm for Creators vs. Gains for Non-Creative Freelancers. In *11th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2)* [\[Paper link\]](#)
- 19. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2024) The Data Economy of Future Mental Healthcare: Curating and Designing with Omnichannel Data. In *Workshop on Designing (with) AI for Well-being at the ACM 2024 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2024)* [\[Paper link\]](#)

18. Hwang, A. H.-C., Friedenbergh, M., Adler, D. A., Mohr, D. C., & Yang, Q. (2022) Searching for the Right Levers to Pull: A Case Study of Bringing Human Considerations to Bear on an AI Cascade. *In Workshop on Situating Network Infrastructure with People, Practices, and Beyond at The ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW 2022)*
17. Hwang, A. H.-C. & Won, A. S. (2022) Bittersweet: Social Comparison and Reliance on Partner Competence in Human-Agent Teamwork. *Work in the Age of Intelligent Machine (WAIM) Research Coordination Network*. [[Paper link](#)]
Received travel support from NSF Future of Work Program
16. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2022) The Look of Trust: How Does Physical Embodiment Shape Trust in Human-Agent Interaction? *In Workshop on Trust and Reliance in AI-Human Teams at the ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2022)*
Selected as Top 10 Workshop Paper at CHI 2022
15. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2022) Dangerously Convincing: Applying Guidelines of Risk Communication Message Design to Human-Centered Explainable AI. *In Workshop on Human-Centered Perspectives in Explainable AI at ACM 2022 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2022)*
14. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2022) Why or Why Not: Barriers of Adopting Generative AI in Human-AI Co-Creativity. *In Workshop on Generative AI and HCI at ACM 2022 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2022)*
13. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2022) Goodbye, Strong AI: Technical Limitations as the Drives for New Theories in Human-Machine Communication. *The 72nd Annual International Communication Conference (ICA 2022)*
Selected as key paper to present at the Human-Machine Communication Pre-Conference
12. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2022) AI with(out) faces: How does representation of AI influence the dynamics in human-AI collaboration? *The 11th Annual Doctoral Consortium of the Communication and Technology Division at the 72nd Annual International Communication Conference. (ICA 2022)*
11. Hwang, A. H.-C. & Oh, J. (2022) Who Sacrificed for Interactive Experience? Investigating the Effect of Interactive Visualization in COVID-19 News on Ethnic Biases. *The 72nd Annual International Communication Conference. (ICA 2022)*
10. Oh, J. & Hwang, A. H.-C. (2022) Interactive COVID-19 News Scares Conservatives More: The Impact of Data Visualization on Fear Arousal and Preventive Intentions. *The 72nd Annual International Communication Conference. (ICA 2022)*
9. Won, A. S., Sabet, M., Hwang, A. H.-C., Cannon, J., Gaddi, V., & McLeod-Daphnis, I. (2022) Effects of Mediated Social Interactions on Pain. *The 72nd Annual International Communication Conference. (ICA 2022)*

8. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2021) Individuality in Human-Centered AI. In *Workshop on “HCAI: Human Centered AI.” The 35th Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2021)* <https://neurips.cc/virtual/2021/48939>
Spotlight paper for oral presentation (<4% of all workshop papers)
7. Hwang, A. H.-C. & Won, A. S. (2021) Group- And Individual-Level Successes in Human-Agent Teams: From Trade-Off to Win-Win. In *Workshop on Human-Machine Partnerships in the Future of Work at the ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW 2021)*
6. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2021) The Virtual Background behind “Me” vs. “Us”: A Cross-Cultural Study of Video-Mediated Communication. *The 71st Annual International Communication Conference (ICA 2021)*
5. Ahn, S. J., Lee, J., Hwang, A. H.-C., Won, A. S., Eden, A., & Guthrie, W. S. (2021) The Utility of Embodied Virtual Spaces for Academic Conferences. *The 71st Annual International Communication Conference (ICA 2021)*
4. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2019) Interactive Data Visualization Influences Subsequent Narrative Persuasion: The Interaction Effect between Body Mass Index (BMI) and Interactivity on Transportation and Intentions to Prevent Obesity. *The 69th Annual International Communication Association Conference (ICA 2019)*
3. Hwang, A. H.-C. (2019) How Interactive Storytelling Persuades: Comparing the Effects of User Engagement and Transportation. *The 69th Annual International Communication Association Conference (ICA 2019)*
2. Hwang, A. H.-C. & Oh, J. (2019) When Consumer Involvement Matters: The Effect of Interactive Music on Consumer Experience and Purchase Intention. *Proceedings of 2019 American Marketing Association Conference (AMA 2019)*
1. Hwang, A. H.-C. & Oh, J. (2018) Can Interactive Music Drive Your Online Shopping Cart? An Experimental Study of Consumer Engagement and Behavioral Intention. *Proceedings of 2018 American Marketing Association Conference (AMA 2018)*

Conference Presentations

(Presentations grouped by research topics)

Longitudinal Effect of Human-AI Companionship

CHI 2026, CHI 2026 Workshop, Comm Horizons Conference 2026

Calibrating Social Experience in Human-AI Collaboration

ICA 2026, CHI 2022, CHI 2022 Latebreaking Work, ICA 2022

Impact of AI Use & Disclosure on Freelance Workers

CSCW 2025, INFORMS 2025, SESP 2025, AOM 2025, IC2S2 2025, CHI 2026

Societal-Scale Human-AI Interaction for Digital Healthcare

CHI 2026, CHI 2024, CHI 2024 Workshop, CSCW 2022 Workshop

Impact of AI Voice Agent on Social Dynamics in Small Groups

CHI 2024, DIS 2024

Creativity Support & Social Facilitation in Human-Agent Teamwork

CHI 2022, CHI 2021

Computer-Mediated Communication during the Worldwide Pandemic

CSCW 2022, CSCW 2021, ICA 2021

Ethnic Biases in Users' Response to Interactive Visualization of Health Data

ICA 2022, ICA 2021, ICA 2019

Mediated Interaction in Virtual Reality for Healthcare

ICA 2022, ICA 2021, IEEE VR 2020

Individuality in Human-Centered AI

NeurIPS 2021

Multimodal User Experience Design on E-Commerce Websites

AMA 2019, IC4E 2019, ICMBT 2019, AMA 2018

Professional Service

University & Departmental Service

2025 – 2026	PhD Admission Committee, Department of Communication, USC
2024 – 2026	Undergraduate Communication Curriculum Committee, USC
2021 – 2022	Communication Graduate Student Association Executive Board, Cornell University
2021 – 2022	Vice President and Student Representative, Graduate and Professional Student Association (GPSA), Cornell University

Research Grant Reviewer & Panelist

2026 –	The Huo Family Foundation
2026 –	National Science Foundation
2025 –	Swiss National Science Foundation

Journal Reviewer (20+ top-tier journals across fields)

**ordered by impact factor (IF)*

British Medical Journal (BMJ) (IF = 43.0)
ACM Computing Surveys (IF = 28.0)
Perspectives on Psychological Science (IF = 12.0)
Telematics and Informatics (IF = 9.2)
Psychology & Marketing (IF = 9.1)
Computers in Human Behavior (IF = 8.9)
Nature BMC (BioMed Central) (IF = 8.3)
ACM Transactions on Computing for Healthcare (ACM Health) (IF = 8.0)
Journal of Medical Internet Research (IF = 6.9)
Nature Behavior Research Methods (IF = 6.8)

Social Media + Society (IF = 6.8)
ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction (TOCHI; IF = 6.6)
New Media & Society (IF = 6.4)
Cyberpsychology Behavior and Social Networking (IF = 6.1)
Information Technology & People (IF = 5.6)
Nature Scientific Reports (IF = 5.5)
Journal of Consumer Behavior (IF = 5.2)
International Journal of Human-Computer Studies (IF = 5.1)
Human-Computer Interaction (IF = 4.9)
International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction (IF = 4.9)
ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction (TOCHI) (IF = 4.8)
ACM Transactions on Interactive Intelligent Systems (TiiS) (IF = 4.8)
Nature Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (IF = 4.0)
Mass Communication & Society (IF = 3.9)
PLOS One (IF = 2.9)
Cognition & Emotion (IF = 2.8)
Behavioral Sciences (IF = 2.5)
Journal of Computational Social Science (IF = 2.5)

Conference Program Committee

AAAI Senior Program Chair, Special Track on AI Alignment, 2027
CHI Associate Chair, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026, 2027
CHI Student Research Competition Jury, 2025
CSCW Program Committee, 2025, 2026
DIS Associate Chair, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
FAccT Program Committee, 2024, 2025, 2026
C&C Associate Chair, 2024, 2025, 2026
ICWSM Senior Program Committee Member, 2026
ICWSM Local Chair, 2026
WebSci Senior Program Committee Member, 2024

Ad Hoc Conference Reviewer

CHI, CSCW, DIS, FAccT, C&C, UbiComp/ISWC, HRI, ICA

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record

2025 – ***Human-AI Interaction***

Department of Communication, University of Southern California
Terms taught: Spring 2025, Spring 2026

- 2026 – ***Communication & Technology***
Department of Communication, University of Southern California
Terms taught: Spring 2026
- 2025 – ***Social & Economic Implications of Technologies***
Department of Communication, University of Southern California
Terms taught: Spring 2025, Fall 2025
- 2022 – 2023 ***Machine Learning for Social Science Research***
Cornell Center for Social Sciences, Cornell University
Terms taught: Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Spring 2023
- 2022 ***What Is Computation?***
Department of Computer Science, Harvard University
Lead lecturer of “Into the Unknown: (De)constructing Creativity in the Age of Human-Machine Partnership”
Term taught: Winter 2022
- 2021 ***Oral Communication***
Department of Communication, Cornell University
Term taught: Summer 2021
- Teaching Assistant**
- 2021 *Communication & Technology*. Department of Communication, Cornell University
- 2020 – 2021 *Oral Communication*. Department of Communication, Cornell University
- 2019 – 2021 *Communication in Virtual World*. Department of Communication, Cornell University
- 2020 *Visual Communication*. Department of Communication, Cornell University
- 2019 *Media Communication*. Department of Communication, Cornell University

Mentorship

Doctoral Dissertation Committee

- Present Fiona Li, Department of Communication, USC
Sui Wang, Department of Communication, USC
Louise Xie, Department of Communication, USC
Jiye Kim, Department of Communication, USC
Eun Cheol Choi, Department of Communication, USC
John Bunyi, USC Suzanne Dworak-Peck School of Social Work
Angelica Sun, EdD in Mental Health, USC Rossier School of Education
Brihi Joshi, Department of Computer Science, USC
Priyanka Dey, Department of Computer Science, USC
Sophie Hsu, Department of Computer Science, USC

Athena Saghi, Department of Computer Science, USC
 Huihan Li, Department of Computer Science, USC
 Yahan Li, Department of Computer Science, USC
 Run Huang, Department of Computer Science, USC

PhD Student First-Year Mentor

2026 - 2027 Kenneth Choi, Department of Communication, USC
 2025 - 2026 Felicia Lu, Department of Communication, USC

Graduate Research Assistants and Interns

2025 – Fiona Li, Department of Communication, USC
 2026 – Elaine Jeon, Department of Communication, USC
 2024 – Chang Wan, Department of Communication, Zhejiang University
 2026 – Chenghui Wu, Department of Linguistics, Peking University
 2023 – 2024 Hauke Sandhaus, Department of Information Science, Cornell Tech
 Zhuoer Lyu, Department of Information Science, Cornell University
 Adhit Sankaran, Department of Computer Science, Cornell University

Undergraduate Mentees & Research Assistants

2025 – 2026 Senya Wang, Marshall School of Business & Viterbi School of Engineering, USC
 2022 - 2023 Wei Yang, Department of Information Science, Cornell University
 James Hwang, Department of Communication, Cornell University
 Ingrid Zhu, Department of Information Science, Cornell University
 2021 - 2022 Shane Labo, Department of Physics, Cornell University
 Esther Lee, Department of Information Science, Cornell University
 Yingyi Shu, Department of Information Science, Cornell University
 2020 - 2021 Oana Mirestean, Department of Computer Science, Cornell University
 Seungmin Lee, Department of Information Science, Cornell University
 Yifei Wang, Department of Communication, Cornell University
 2019 - 2020 Emily Chin, Department of Information Science, Cornell University
 Joshua Levine, Department of Information Science, Cornell University
 Hal Rives, Department of Biology, Cornell University

Media Coverage

06/2026 Psychology Today. “*The Dilution of Therapy With AI Para-therapy*” [\[url\]](#)
 03/2026 Cornell Chronicle. “*Are mental health apps like doctors, yogis, drugs or supplements?*”
[\[url\]](#)
 01/2026 Cal Matters. “*Can AI help make homeless Californians healthier?*” [\[url\]](#)
 11/2025 Georgia Tech News Center. “*Researchers Look to Make Safer AI Through Google Awards*” [\[url\]](#)
 11/2025 Cornell Chronicle. “*Why companies don’t share AV crash data – and how they could*”
[\[url\]](#)

10/2025 Cornell Chronicle. *"Pain tolerance increases during social interaction in VR"* [\[url\]](#)

10/2025 ACM CSCW Blog. *"The power of imperfection: Flawed AI images to spark design conversations"* [\[url\]](#)

01/2025 ZD Net. *"Writers voice anxiety about using AI. Readers don't seem to care"* [\[url\]](#)

06/2024 Lab Manager. *"Working Alongside an AI 'Teammate' Encourages Participation from Women"* [\[url\]](#)

06/2024 Tech Xplore. *"Study demonstrates female AI 'teammate' engenders more participation from women"* [\[url\]](#)

06/2024 The Debrief. *"Gendered AI Partner Boosts Participation and Productivity From Women in Team Projects"* [\[url\]](#)

06/2024 Cornell Chronicle. *"Female AI 'teammate' generates more participation from women"* [\[url\]](#)

06/2024 Science Daily. *"Female AI 'teammate' generates more participation from women"* [\[url\]](#)

06/2024 News Reel. *"Female AI voices empower women in teams"* [\[url\]](#)

10/2022 Stanford Digital Education. *"Chatbot guides students to learn and reflect"* [\[url\]](#)

06/2021 Business Wire. *"Juji, Inc. Powers Cornell University Study on Human-Machine Team Creativity"* [\[url\]](#)